



FOSS Bytes

IBM responds to Windows 7 launch with Ubuntu Desktop

With an aim to take away the forthcoming market share from Microsoft's most talked-about Windows 7 (launched on October 22, 2009), the biggest rival IBM is teaming up with Canonical against Windows 7. In September, the company struck a partnership with Canonical, which resulted in the launch of an Ubuntu-based desktop bundle in Africa. Now, the cloud and Ubuntu-based software package, which is part of IBM's Smart Work Initiative, will soon be debuting in the US.

Independent market estimates range up to \$2,000 for the cost of migrating to the Windows 7 operating system for many PC users. New PC hardware requirements account for a significant portion of the added expense. However, the Ubuntu-based desktop package includes IBM's free Lotus Symphony productivity suite; e-mail from IBM Lotus Notes or the cloud-based LotusLive iNotes which starts at \$3 per user, per month; Cloud-based, social networking and collaboration tools from LotusLive.com from \$10 per user, per month; and Ubuntu, an open platform for netbooks, laptops, desktops, and servers.

The IBM Client for Smart Work will only arrive in the U.S. in 2010 despite IBM positioning it to rival Windows 7 in the enterprise market. It will be available both as a run-of-the-mill desktop and as a virtualised desktop.



LF announces second annual End User Summit

The Linux Foundation has announced the speaker line-up and details for its second annual End User Summit. The Summit is a unique opportunity for corporate end users to learn and interact with leaders from within the Linux community. It will take place on November 9-10, 2009 at the Hyatt Jersey City on the Hudson (in New Jersey, USA). "In its second year, the Summit will facilitate collaboration among Linux community members who, until recently, did not have the opportunity to discuss, face-to-face, the most pressing new usage models and demands facing the Linux platform," said Jim Zemlin, executive director at The Linux Foundation. The Summit is sponsored by IBM and Intel and is by invitation only. To request for an invitation, please visit the Summit website [<http://events.linuxfoundation.org/events/end-user-summit>].

Mickos to EU: Oracle's Sun takeover not 'anti-competitive'

MySQL's former CEO, Marten Mickos, is sending a heartfelt plea to the European Union to wave through Oracle's takeover of Sun Microsystems. Mickos left MySQL earlier this year—just over a year after Sun bought his open source database outfit—after apparently becoming frustrated with the bureaucracy at Sun. With Oracle's takeover of Sun—and the prospect of Larry Ellison killing Mickos' open source baby—industry watchers might have expected the deal to further fuel his ire. Instead, Mickos has written to the EU competition commissioner, Neelie Kroes, to say that while the EU was absolutely right to launch an investigation into the deal, it should give the takeover the 'OK' as quickly as possible. Every day the EU holds up the deal, he argues, actually reduces competition in the market as Sun's business withers, and investment in 'open source ventures' slows down.



Nokia releases official Qt port to Maemo 5

Nokia has announced the creation of the official Qt port to Maemo 5 and published an initial Technology Preview release. This port to Maemo 5 means that developers can now use Qt to target the upcoming Nokia N900 device, and also

ensures that applications can be easily ported to all Qt's supported platforms including

the next Maemo 6 release, as well as Symbian and Windows Mobile.

It is designed specifically to work within the Maemo 5 environment, which will power the Nokia N900 device. The port itself will be based on Qt's upcoming version 4.6 and is scheduled for release in Q1 of 2010. Visit qt.nokia.com/maemo for details.



Google joins Open Screen Project

Google has joined Adobe's Open Screen Project [openscreenproject.org], an initiative established a year and a half ago to help developers design content more easily for the Web across multiple screens, using the Flash platform.

According to Google, "We've always believed that open platforms lead to greater innovation on the Web, and we see participating in the Open Screen Project as another step in that direction. We're excited to continue working with the teams at Adobe on pushing the Web forward, and to see where the next generation of Web development will take us."

The project includes close to 50 industry leaders working together to provide a consistent runtime environment across mobile phones, desktops and other consumer electronic devices.